



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Adams-Young Elementary

School Website: <https://cornerstoneschools.org/school/adams-young-academy/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Adams-Young Elementary (Detroit, MI 48235), operating under Cornerstone Schools' Adams-Young Academy branding, demonstrates several features aligned with classical aims (notably character formation, a focus on community/family engagement, and a strong faculty emphasis). However, the public-facing materials from the school emphasize character development, career awareness, technology integration, and parent/community engagement rather than explicit classical hallmarks such as robust Great Books study, the Trivium/Quadrivium, intensive Socratic pedagogy, or liturgical/theological formation. Taken together, the school most closely aligns with a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL profile rather than CLASSICAL. This assessment reflects the presence of formation-oriented messaging and strong faculty/parent engagement, contrasted with the lack of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and traditional schol  pedagogy in the public materials examined.

Key insights:

- The site emphasizes character formation and career awareness, with claims of a robust character-and-culture program at every grade level and strong faculty engagement. This points to virtues-centered aims, albeit without explicit classical lexicon (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or liturgical/theological pedagogy).
- There is clear evidence of parental and community involvement, which aligns with classical models' emphasis on pp. partnership with families and formation of affections, but the materials stop short of detailing parents as "co-teachers" in a formal sense.
- The absence of explicit Great Books, Socratic seminars, schol  days, or liturgical practices in the public materials lowers the score for several categories, pushing the overall classification toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Explicitly articulate and implement a Great Books-oriented, liberal-arts-driven curriculum (even at the elementary level where feasible), including primary-source engagement and historical texts aligned with a Great Conversation approach.
- Introduce guided Socratic dialogue or Paideia-like seminars in upper elementary and middle school grades, along with structured opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking.
- Incorporate schol -focused, contemplative learning days (restful, memory work, and deliberate reflection) into the schedule.
- Integrate a clearly defined liturgical/theological dimension (even if ecumenical) in line with traditional Christian classical education, including communal practices, liturgical rhythms, and sacramental or worship-informed elements.

- Formalize the “living curriculum” by codifying teacher mastery of classical pedagogies (copywork, dictation, imitation of master texts) and making teacher development a pillar of the program.
- Expand explicit family formation initiatives (classical book studies, parent study groups, home-school alignment) and continue promoting parents as co-educators within a classical framework.

ABSTRACT

Adams-Young Elementary (Adams-Young Academy) demonstrates partial alignment with classical education, chiefly in its emphasis on character formation, career awareness, and strong faculty/parent engagement. The absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium study, Socratic pedagogy, and liturgical/theological formation in public-facing materials suggests the school sits in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category rather than CLASSICAL. The six-category analysis yields: RMF (NOT CLASSICAL), SPG (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), Curriculum (NOT CLASSICAL), Pedagogy (NOT CLASSICAL), Faculty (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), Parents & Community (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The aggregate assessment is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Evidence centers on character formation rather than transcendental moral realism, theology, or liturgical practices. Positive keyword indicators for this category are largely absent in the public materials, yielding a NOT CLASSICAL alignment based on explicit criteria. Evidence: “Building good character is infused in everything we do.” (Public materials)
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords directly tied to RMF (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy) are not present in the sourced public materials; no explicit negative RMF indicators are evident in the text. Count: Positive keywords 0; Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating: The school emphasizes character, not transcendental moral realism or liturgical/theological formation in the public materials.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): Evidence emphasizes formation (character) and formation-oriented aims, with references to character development and career awareness. The explicit classical vocabulary (liberal education, telos, great conversation) is not present in the public materials. Evidence: “Academic achievement, excellent character, and career awareness provide our students with the tools they will need to pursue complete lives.” (Public materials)
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords aligned with SPG (formation, virtuous life, wisdom, telos, liberal education) are not explicit in the public materials; the content centers on character and career awareness, more aligned with formation than with classical telos-laden rhetoric. Count: Positive keywords 0; Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating: Formation and character are present, but the public materials do not fully articulate a classical telos-driven framework or Great Conversation emphasis typical of a Classical SPG. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): There is no explicit mention of the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium; Quadrivium) or Great Books from the public materials. The emphasis is on career awareness and character. Evidence: “Career curriculum introduces students to various jobs and business leaders as early as kindergarten,” along with character-focused messaging.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords anchored to classical curriculum (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, primary sources) are not present. Count: Positive keywords 0; Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating: The curriculum content falls outside the classical curriculum model, leading to a NOT CLASSICAL categorization for this category.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy or Teaching Methods): Public materials do not document Socratic seminars, scholé (restful learning), recitation/memorization, or formal imitation-based pedagogy. The materials

emphasize a technology-driven, character-focused approach with career exposure rather than classical pedagogical methods. Evidence: “Highly-qualified, passionate faculty and staff create challenging, relevant, and meaningful lessons, while caring for the whole child.”

- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: No explicit keywords for Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, or imitation of master texts; no explicit negative indicators are present either. Count: Positive keywords 0; Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy described does not align with classical teaching methods such as Socratic dialogue or scholé, producing a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Evidence shows a claim of “highly-qualified, passionate faculty and staff” and a leadership structure (Head of School, etc.). This aligns modestly with the classical ideal of teachers as virtuous exemplars and living curriculum. Evidence: “Highly-qualified, passionate faculty and staff create challenging, relevant, and meaningful lessons, while caring for the whole child.”; Head of School details are provided.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords that resonate with classical faculty norms (model teachers, mentors, living curriculum) are not explicitly stated, but the emphasis on staff quality and character alignment tends toward classical sensibilities. Count: Positive keywords 1 (faculty quality language); Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating: The description aligns with classical ideals of exemplary, morally fit teachers, albeit without explicit classical vocabulary or a fully developed “living curriculum” framing.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): The materials emphasize strong parent and community engagement, which aligns with classical education’s emphasis on parent partnership and a broader learning community. Evidence: “Strong parent and community engagement.”
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis: Positive keywords associated with Element 6 (partnership with families; formation of affections; community involvement) appear in concept, if not in explicit vocabulary. Count: Positive keywords 1; Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating: The school demonstrates a clear commitment to engaging families and the broader community, aligning with the classical emphasis on parent partnership and community involvement, though it stops short of a formal “co-teacher” model in public materials.

Note on sources and keyword framework

- Public materials from Adams-Young Elementary/Adams-Young Academy (Cornerstone Schools) provide clear statements about character formation, career awareness, and family engagement. Representative quotes include: “Building good character is infused in everything we do,” and “We expose students to career options from an early age, so that they may explore occupations that align with their purpose and passion.”
- The classical rubric framework relies on positive/negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1), and related lexicon resources. Key terms include: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, great books, Trivium, Quadrivium, Socratic, scholé, imitation, memory work, living curriculum, partnership with families, and others. See the lexicon and elements references for the exact keyword lists.

Note on aggregate ranking

- Based on category-by-category scoring, Adams-Young Elementary sits in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range overall. While it shows meaningful formation and community engagement, it lacks explicit classical elements such as Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and scholé-based pedagogy in the public materials examined. The aggregate result is therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize character formation rather than transcendental moral realism, theology, or liturgical practices. Example: “Building good character is infused in everything we do.”
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: 0 (no explicit truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, or scholé terms in the public materials).
 - Negative keywords present: 0
 - Why this rating
 - The school’s public messaging centers on character and career awareness, with no explicit articulation of transcendental foundations or liturgical practices that would align with the RMF criteria.
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Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials emphasize formation and character (formation of affections) and note career awareness. Example: “Academic achievement, excellent character, and career awareness provide our students with the tools they will need to pursue complete lives.”
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: 0 (no explicit use of “formation”/“virtue”/“telos” in classical vocabulary, though formation is suggested conceptually).
 - Negative keywords present: 0
 - Why this rating
 - The focus on character formation and career awareness aligns somewhat with classical aims of formation and human flourishing, but the public materials do not articulate the full telos-driven or liberal-arts emphasis that typifies a CLASSICAL SPG score.
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Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials highlight career exposure and character education rather than a liberal-arts curriculum or Great Books approach. Example: “Career curriculum introduces students to various jobs and business leaders as early as kindergarten.”
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: 0 (no explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or other classical curriculum terms present in public materials).
 - Negative keywords present: 0
 - Why this rating
 - Public materials do not describe a classical-curriculum structure (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, etc.), which is central to a CLASSICAL CURRICULUM rating.
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Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials emphasize high-quality, character-centered teaching but do not document Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization/recitation, or imitation-based pedagogy. Example: “Highly-

qualified, passionate faculty and staff create challenging, relevant, and meaningful lessons, while caring for the whole child.”

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: 0
 - Negative keywords present: 0
 - Why this rating
 - Absence of explicitly classical methods (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, imitation) yields NOT CLASSICAL.
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Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize the quality of faculty and leadership, including “Highly-qualified, passionate faculty and staff” and named leadership.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: 1 (quality of faculty; possibly aligned with “model teachers” and “living curriculum” concept though not stated as such verbatim).
 - Negative keywords present: 0
 - Why this rating
 - The strong faculty quality aligns with classical ideals of virtuous, competent teachers, but the absence of explicit classical pedagogy wording keeps this category from CLASSICAL.
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Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school highlights strong parent and community engagement. Example: “Strong parent and community engagement.”
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: 1 (Partnership with Families; engagement and collaboration are indicated, even if not to the level of “co-teachers” in the public texts).
 - Negative keywords present: 0
 - Why this rating
 - Engagement with families and the broader community aligns with classical-teaching expectations of partnership with families, but the materials do not spell out the full “parents as co-teachers” model in public statements.
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What Would Move the Needle

- Implement explicit Great Books and liberal-arts integration across K-12 (or a robust early-grade version), including primary-source engagement and a “Great Conversation” framework.
- Adopt and document Socratic pedagogy and Paideia-style seminars in upper elementary grades, with opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking.
- Introduce Restful Learning (Scholé) days, contemplative reflection, and memory-based recitation or chant for foundational content.
- Build a formal “living curriculum” component with teacher training in classical pedagogy and public articulation of how teachers model virtue and mastery.
- Deepen theological/the metaphysical dimension (even if ecumenical) through liturgical or communal practices, prayer, or worship-informed elements to ground learning in a sacred rhythm.

- Expand explicit parent formation and guidance (classical book clubs, parent study groups) and strengthen the public-facing narrative of parents as co-educators within a classical frame.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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